

ROS 2: motion planning

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MoveIt★ – the standard *ROS 2* framework for robot manipulation:

- motion planning
- kinematics
- collision checking
- trajectory generation
- execution
- for: robotic arms, grippers, mobile manipulators, and similar systems

MoveIt OSS (open source) is free under a BSD license for industrial, commercial, and research use

MoveIt Pro★

- paid annual license + paid services
- behaviors, skills, behavior trees, mobile manipulation and navigation, ML, digital twin

MoveIt

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MoveIt:

- nodes
- tools
- *plugin*-based (*pluginlib*)
- uses *OMPL*

The Open Motion Planning Library (OMPL) ★

- many state-of-the-art sampling-based motion planning algorithms
- no code related to, e.g., collision checking or visualization

Note about *MoveIt* documentation:

- docs are distributed along multiple sites (usually redundant)
- some diagrams and descriptions are not migrated from *ROS 1*
- *MoveIt* for *ROS 2* is called *MoveIt 2*

MoveIt pipeline★

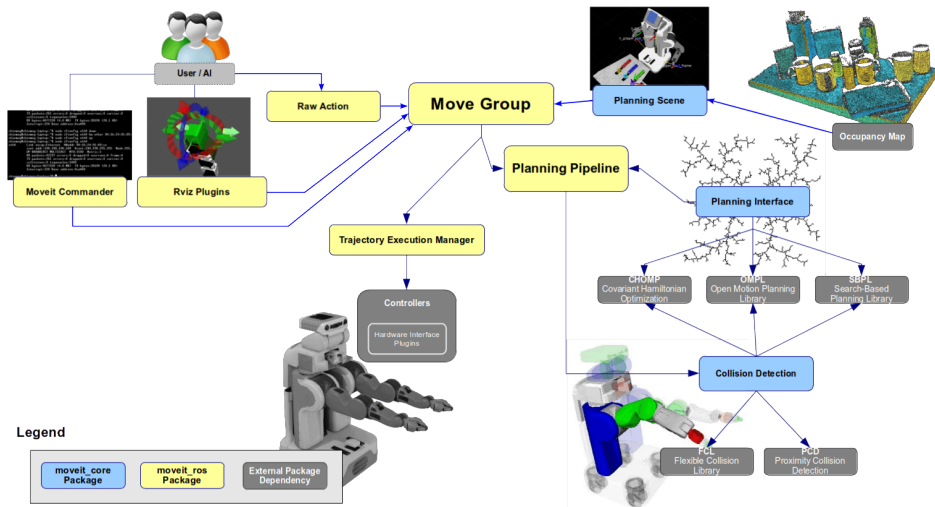


image source: <https://moveit.picknik.ai/main/doc/concepts/concepts.html>

`move_group`★ is a central *node* of *Movel*t

- provides *services* and *actions* callable from:
 - ◇ *nodes* in C++ – through `move_group_interface`
 - ◇ *nodes* in Python – through `MoveItPy`
 - ◇ *rviz2* – through `MotionPlanning` visualization panel
 - ◇ *CLI*
- reads sensors *topics* and manages the planning scene
- perform path / trajectory planning and IK
- commands trajectory execution to `ros2_control`

`move_group` may run several child *nodes*, including:

- planning scene monitor
- a client *node* for interacting with `controller_manager`

Note: do not set the name of `move_group` *node*

- this will set the same name for all child nodes and cause problems!
- use *namespace* instead, if needed (multiple robots?)

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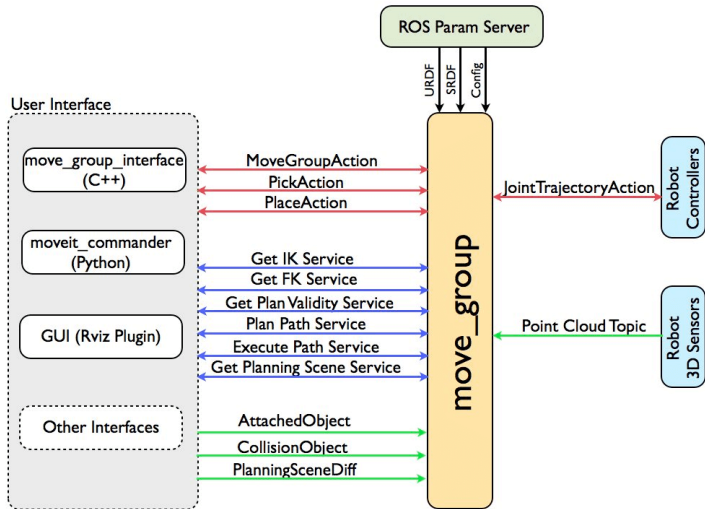


image source: https://moveit.picknik.ai/main/doc/concepts/move_group.html

Figure: The `move_group` node (note: this diagram is for ROS 1)

MoveIt Setup Assistant★

- used to create or edit a robot's MoveIt configuration package
- GUI tool
- input: robot description (*URDF* / *xacro*)
- generates the semantic (*SRDF*) and *.yaml* configuration files needed by:
 - ◇ *move_group*
 - ◇ *rviz2* Motion Planning panel
 - ◇ kinematics solvers, planners
 - ◇ trajectory execution
- output (*SRDF*, *.yaml*, *xacro*):
 - ◇ planning groups
 - ◇ end effectors
 - ◇ disabled collision pairs
 - ◇ named poses
 - ◇ passive joints
 - ◇ kinematics settings
 - ◇ controller mappings

MoveIt Setup Assistant generates a *package*

```
my_robot_moveit_config/  
├── config/  
│   ├── joint_limits.yaml  
│   ├── kinematics.yaml  
│   ├── moveit_controllers.yaml  
│   ├── my_robot.srdf  
│   ├── my_robot.urdf.xacro  
│   ├── my_robot.ros2_control.xacro  
│   ├── ompl_planning.yaml  
│   ├── ros2_controllers.yaml  
│   ├── sensors_3d.yaml  
│   └── ...  
├── launch/  
│   ├── move_group.launch.py  
│   ├── rviz.launch.py  
│   ├── demo.launch.py  
│   └── ...  
├── .setup_assistant  
├── package.xml  
└── CMakeLists.txt
```

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MoveIt and simulation

MoveIt Setup Assistant does not generate controllers for simulation

move_group launch file does not read *parameter* use_sim_time

This causes the following error:

```
[rviz2-10] [WARN] [1780838151.257620804] [rviz2.moveit.ros.planning_scene_monitor]: Maybe failed to update robot state, time diff: 1780838135.251s
```

Fixes:

- rewrite the function generate_move_group_launch★
- or download the move_group launch file★

Minimal set of nodes for running *Movel*t:

- *controller_manager* (*ros2_control* or *gz_ros2_control*)
 - ◊ *hardware components*
 - ◊ *joint_state_broadcaster*
 - ◊ trajectory controllers
- *robot_state_publisher*
- *move_group* and all its child *nodes*

Usual additions:

- *rviz2* with Motion Planning *plugin*
- perception nodes

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Using *MoveIt* – API

In *rviz2* + *MotionPlanning* panel★:

- most of *MoveIt* functions available from GUI

In a C++ *node*★:

- through `MoveGroupInterface` class

In a Python *node*★:

- through `MoveItPy` class in `moveit.planning` module
- it is convenient to use `moveit_py.yaml` (the configuration for `moveit_py`)

By calling a service or action

- C++ / Python classes, *rviz2 plugin* are using *move_group* services and actions

Configuring *MoveIt* is difficult, but it is a one-time procedure

Planning Scene Monitor★

Planning Scene Monitor

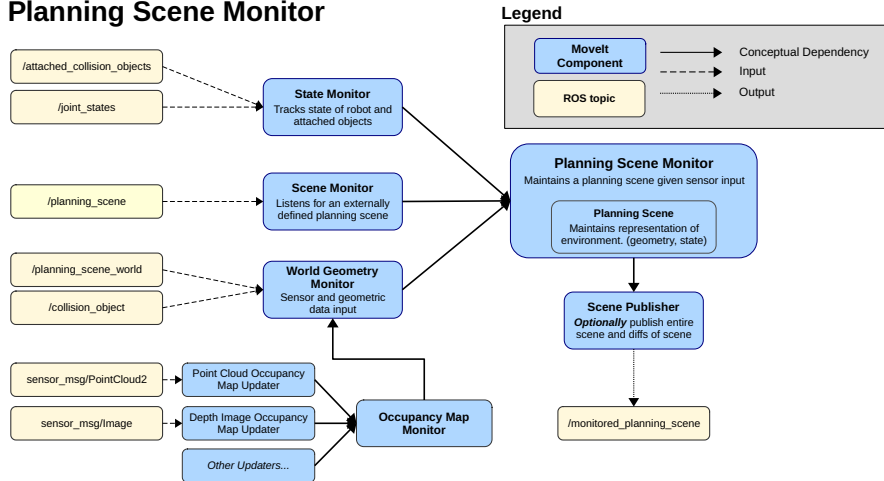
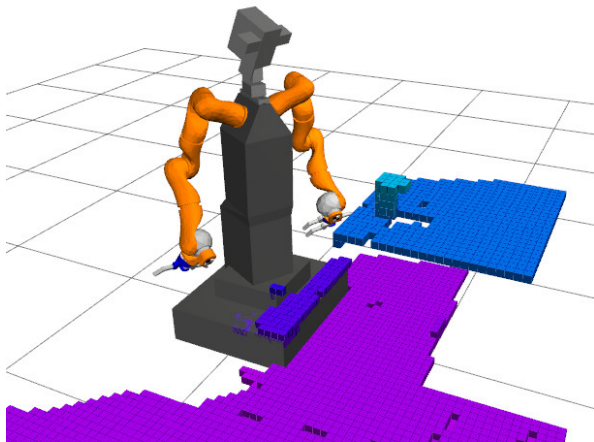


image source: https://moveit.picknik.ai/main/doc/concepts/planning_scene_monitor.html

3D sensor data → octomap



Sense, plan and act

Typical use:

1. sense

- ◇ use sensors' data to build environment model
- ◇ send the model to *move_group node*

2. plan

- ◇ determine starting and goal configurations
- ◇ inform the *move_group node* about attached objects and constraints (for the goal and trajectory)
- ◇ trigger motion planning

3. act

- ◇ execute the generated path

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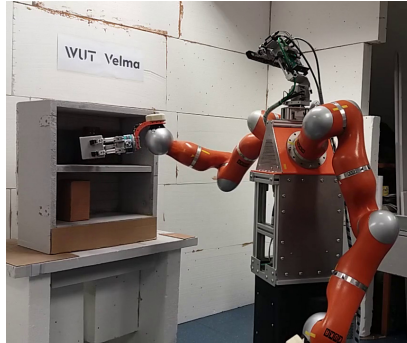
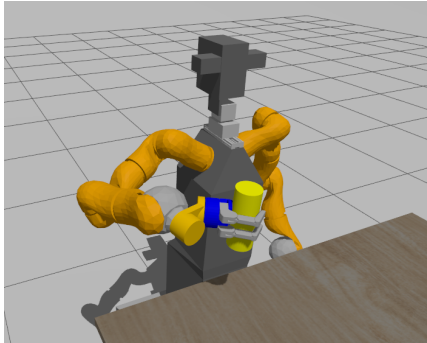
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WUT Velma robot – simulation



https://github.com/dseredyn/wut_velma_ws

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Questions?